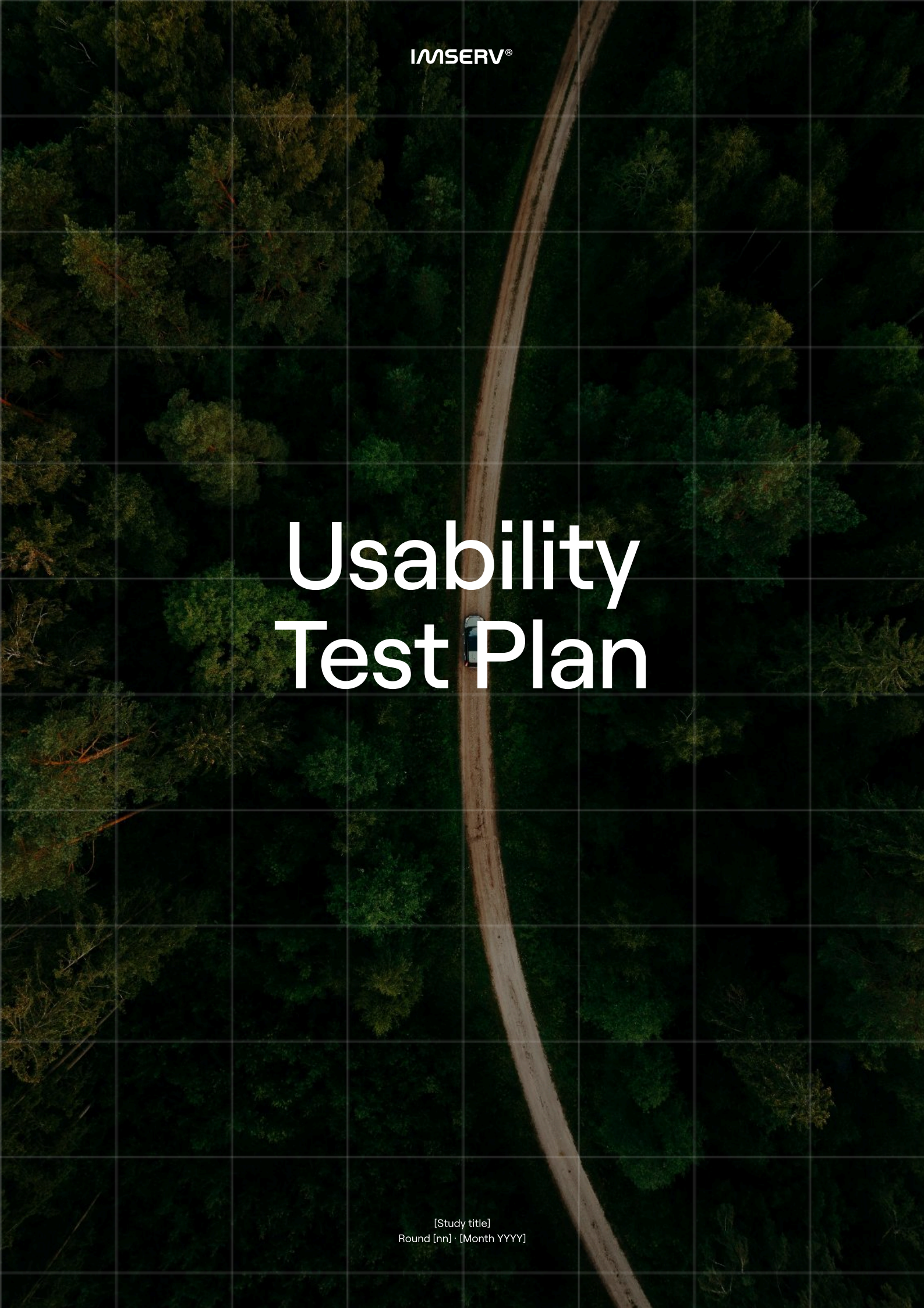
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Usability Test Plan

[Study title]
Round [nn] · [Month YYYY]

Summary



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Why we are testing this

Background

[One or two sentences. Name the product area and the decision this round must inform.]

Decision to inform

[What are we deciding? For example, whether to ship, change or drop a flow before [milestone].]

If we are wrong

[What happens if our current assumption is wrong? Who is affected and how badly?]

KNOWN

- [Established finding]
  Source: [study ID, analytics, UXDR, support]
- [Established finding]
  Source: [ ]

ASSUMED

- [Belief we hold without enough evidence]
- [Belief we hold without enough evidence]

UNKNOWN

- [Uncertainty that matters to the decision]
- [Uncertainty that matters to the decision]

Guidance · delete before issue. Evidence before research. Search `docs/research/`, `docs/ux/`, analytics, support and earlier rounds first. Every Known item needs a source. If existing evidence already answers the decision, stop here and reuse it. Do not run this study.

Objectives and questions

PRIMARY RESEARCH QUESTION

[The one question this round must answer]

1

[Understand · Evaluate · Identify · Determine]

OBJECTIVE

[Verb, then what the study must learn]

RESEARCH QUESTION

[The question that tests it]

ANSWERED BY

[Discovery / Task n / Closing]

DECISION IT FEEDS

[What changes depending on the answer]

EVIDENCE WE NEED

[Observed behaviour, explanation, rating]

2

[Objective name]

OBJECTIVE

[Verb, then what the study must learn]

RESEARCH QUESTION

[The question that tests it]

ANSWERED BY

[Discovery / Task n / Closing]

DECISION IT FEEDS

[What changes depending on the answer]

EVIDENCE WE NEED

[Observed behaviour, explanation, rating]

3

[Objective name]

OBJECTIVE

[Verb, then what the study must learn]

RESEARCH QUESTION

[The question that tests it]

ANSWERED BY

[Discovery / Task n / Closing]

DECISION IT FEEDS

[What changes depending on the answer]

EVIDENCE WE NEED

[Observed behaviour, explanation, rating]

4

[Objective name]

OBJECTIVE

[Verb, then what the study must learn]

RESEARCH QUESTION

[The question that tests it]

ANSWERED BY

[Discovery / Task n / Closing]

DECISION IT FEEDS

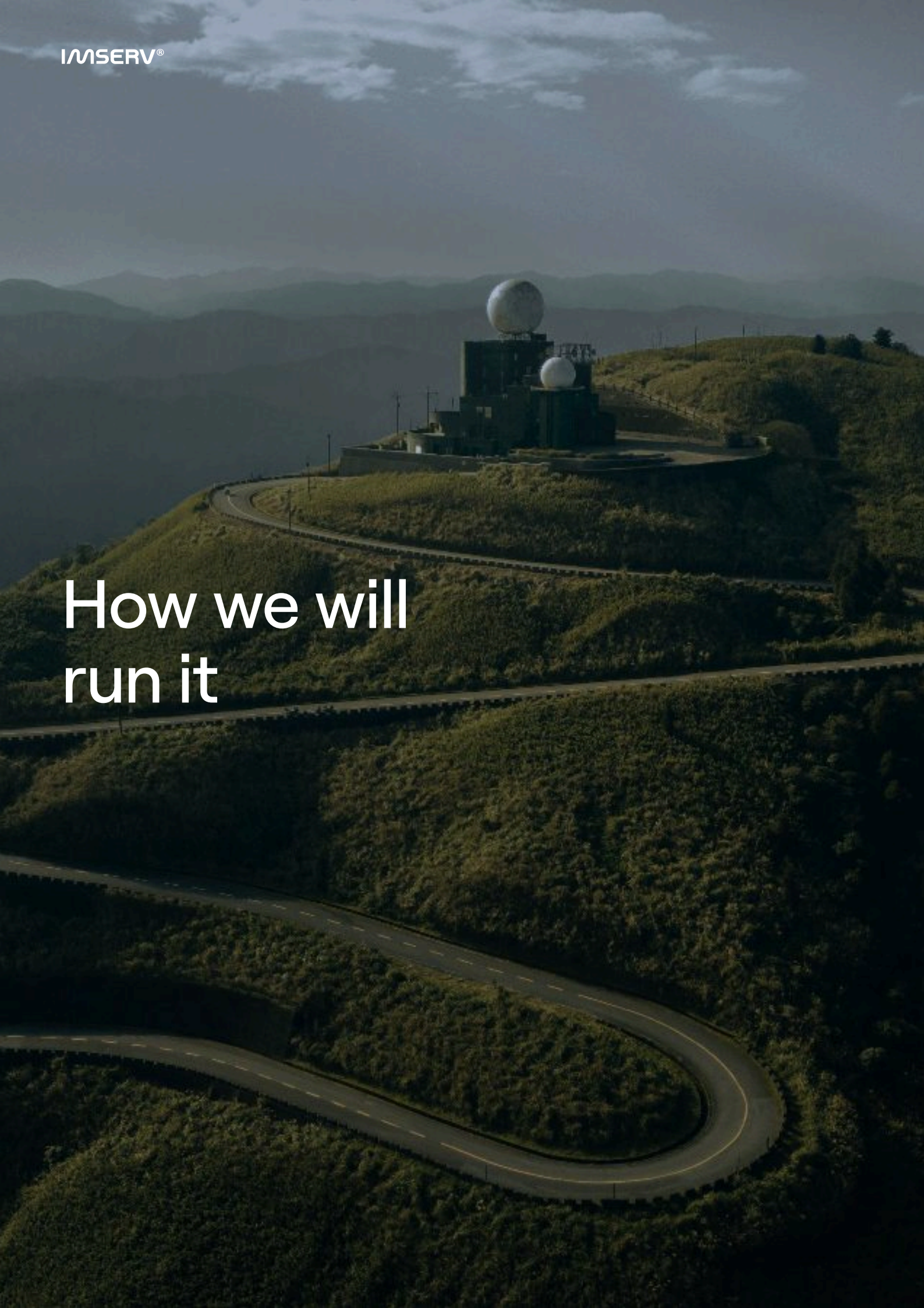
[What changes depending on the answer]

EVIDENCE WE NEED

[Observed behaviour, explanation, rating]

Guidance · delete before issue. Write objectives as things the study must understand. Avoid “get feedback”, “see what people think” and “test the design”. Example: *Evaluate whether administrators can create a company and configure access without assistance.* Each objective appears again in the matrix on page 18.

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How we will run it

Method and logistics

A moderated usability test lets us watch people attempt realistic tasks. If the question is *why* people behave as they do, or *how common* a behaviour is, choose another method.

Item	Plan	Owner	Status
Method	Moderated usability test, [remote / in person]	[Name]	To confirm
Why this method	[How observing tasks answers the primary research question]	[Name]	To confirm
Format	[Platform]. Think-aloud optional. Silence is data.	[Name]	To confirm
Session length	[60] minutes, [15] minutes between sessions	[Name]	To confirm
Stimulus	[Prototype name], version [x.y], [link or commit]	[Name]	To confirm
Test environment	[Test accounts, data set, devices, browsers. Reset steps between sessions]	[Name]	To confirm
Recording	[Screen and audio]. Stored in [location], kept for [period]	[Name]	To confirm
Roles	One moderator, one note-taker, up to [n] silent observers	[Name]	To confirm
Pilot	[Date] with a colleague who did not design the flow	[Name]	To confirm

Sample at a glance

This is a qualitative round. It finds issues and explains behaviour. Scores are directional. Do not report them as how common a problem is across all customers.

Participants this round

[4–8]

[60] minutes each
[remote / in person]

Participants and recruitment

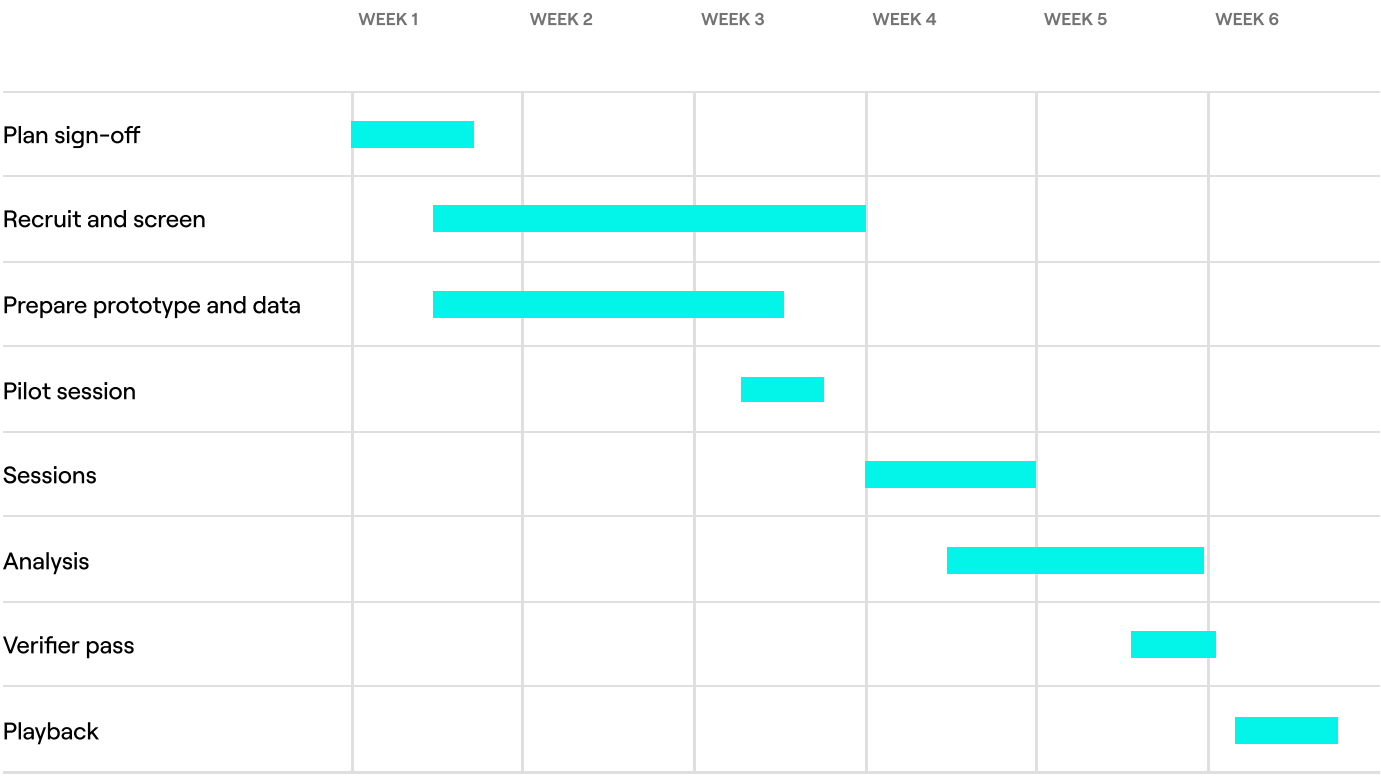
Who takes part must match the decision. Recruit on what people do, not on job title alone. One role cannot stand in for another.

Criterion	Requirement	Why it matters
Role and organisation	[Role at organisation type]	[Link to the decision]
Behaviour	[Has done the task under study in the last [n] months]	[ ]
Tool experience	[Current users, newcomers, or a mix]	[ ]
Mix	[n] of [segment A], [n] of [segment B]	[ ]
Exclusions	Internal staff when testing customers. Anyone who designed the flow. [Others]	[ ]
Accessibility	[Ask at screening: assistive technology, captions, extra time, breaks]	[ ]
Incentive	[Amount or none. Approved by [name]]	[ ]
Screener	Behavioural questions only. Confirm they do the work. [Link]	[ ]

Guidance · delete before issue. Screening data is identifiable. Keep it out of this plan and any deck. Use P01, P02 in every output. Never leave real or invented names, emails or companies in a shared artefact.

Schedule

Six weeks from sign-off to playback. Replace week numbers with dates once recruitment is confirmed.



The session

Running order

One session, [60] minutes. The moderator keeps time. Drop a task before cutting the closing questions.

−10 MIN

Tech check

Join early. Test sound, screen share and the prototype link.

−5 MIN

Reset

Clear test data. Open the start screen. Observers muted, cameras off.

00:00

Welcome and consent

Read the preamble on page 13. Record consent against the participant ID.

00:05

Discovery

Their current world. No stimulus yet. Page 14.

00:15

Task 1

[Task name]

00:23

Task 2

[Task name]

00:31

Task 3

[Task name]

00:39

Task 4

[Task name]

00:47

Closing questions

Measures and reflection. Page 16.

00:55

Thank you

Explain next steps and the incentive. Stop the recording.

+10 MIN

Debrief

Moderator, note-taker and observers. What we saw, not what we would build.

+24 HRS

Tidy notes

Add timestamps. Keep observation and interpretation apart.

Neutral draft. Swap in the project's approved consent wording. Legal review before it reaches a participant.

Consent and preamble

Read aloud at the start of every session. No new terms. No invented legal wording.

Consent covers

- Who is running the research
- Why we are doing it
- What data we collect
- Recording, and who watches
- How long we keep it, and where
- Any other organisation that processes it
- That they can stop or withdraw at any time
- Permission for anonymised quotation

Record consent against each participant ID. If quotation consent is unknown, the quote stays out of every deck.

Preamble

Thank you for joining.

I am [name] from [organisation]. I did not build this product. I am here to learn how this work is for you.

We are looking at [purpose in plain language]. We are testing the product, not you. There are no right answers. If something is unclear, that is useful to us.

The session is about [60] minutes. You can skip a question or stop at any time.

We would like to [record the screen and audio]. [Product colleagues] are watching on mute.

We will [how data is stored, who sees it, how long, how to withdraw].

Do you have any questions before we start? Are you happy to take part on that basis?

Discovery

Ten minutes on their current world, before they see anything. Ask about real, recent behaviour.

Questions

1. Tell me about your role and where [area] fits in it.
2. Tell me about the last time you [did the task under study].
3. What did you use to do it? Who else was involved?
4. What, if anything, got in the way?
5. How did you know it had worked?
6. [Question tied to Objective [n]]

Neutral probes

- What makes you say that?
- Can you show me?
- What happened next?
- What, if anything, was unclear?

Avoid

- Leading or loaded questions
- Two questions in one
- "Would you use…?" Observe instead
- "Do you like…?" without asking why
- Explaining the interface before a task

ANCHOR PROMPT

"Tell me about the last time you [did the task under study]."

Tasks

One goal per task. State the outcome, not the click path. Use the participant's words unless the label itself is under test. Agree success before the first session.

1

[Task name] · Objective [n]

SCENARIO · READ ALOUD

[You are … You need to …]

SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

[Observable end state]

AFTER THE TASK

Ease, then confidence. "What do you think happened?"

STARTING POINT

[Screen, account and data they begin with]

WATCH FOR

[Hesitation, wrong path, scope-checking]

MEASURES

Success · Ease · Confidence

2

[Task name] · Objective [n]

SCENARIO · READ ALOUD

[You are … You need to …]

SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

[Observable end state]

AFTER THE TASK

Ease, then confidence. "What would you expect next?"

STARTING POINT

[Screen, account and data they begin with]

WATCH FOR

[Hesitation, wrong path, scope-checking]

MEASURES

Success · Ease · Confidence

3

[Task name] · Objective [n]

SCENARIO · READ ALOUD

[You are … You need to …]

SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

[Observable end state]

AFTER THE TASK

[Only probes that serve the objective]

STARTING POINT

[Screen, account and data they begin with]

WATCH FOR

[Hesitation, wrong path, scope-checking]

MEASURES

Success · Ease · Confidence

4

[Task name] · Objective [n]

SCENARIO · READ ALOUD

[You are … You need to …]

SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

[Observable end state]

AFTER THE TASK

[Only probes that serve the objective]

STARTING POINT

[Screen, account and data they begin with]

WATCH FOR

[Hesitation, wrong path, scope-checking]

MEASURES

Success · Ease · Confidence

Guidance · delete before issue. During the task use only "What are you looking for?", "What would you do next?" and "What, if anything, is unclear?". Do not rescue until they give up or ask. Note assists, errors, hesitation and scope-checking.

Measures

Only measures that serve a named objective. From four to eight people, every score is directional. Do not announce a precise lift.

Measure	Scale	When	Objective
Task success	Success · Success with assist · Fail	Each task	[n]
Ease (SEQ)	1 Very difficult to 7 Very easy	After each task	[n]
Confidence	1 Not at all to 7 Completely	After each task	[n]
Time on task	Seconds from scenario read to stated done	If planned	[n]
Errors and assists	Count, with a description of each	Each task	[n]

Closing questions

1. Looking back over everything, what stood out?
2. If you could change one thing, what would it be? What makes you say that?
3. [Comparison with their current tool, if it serves an objective]
4. Is there anything we did not ask that we should have?

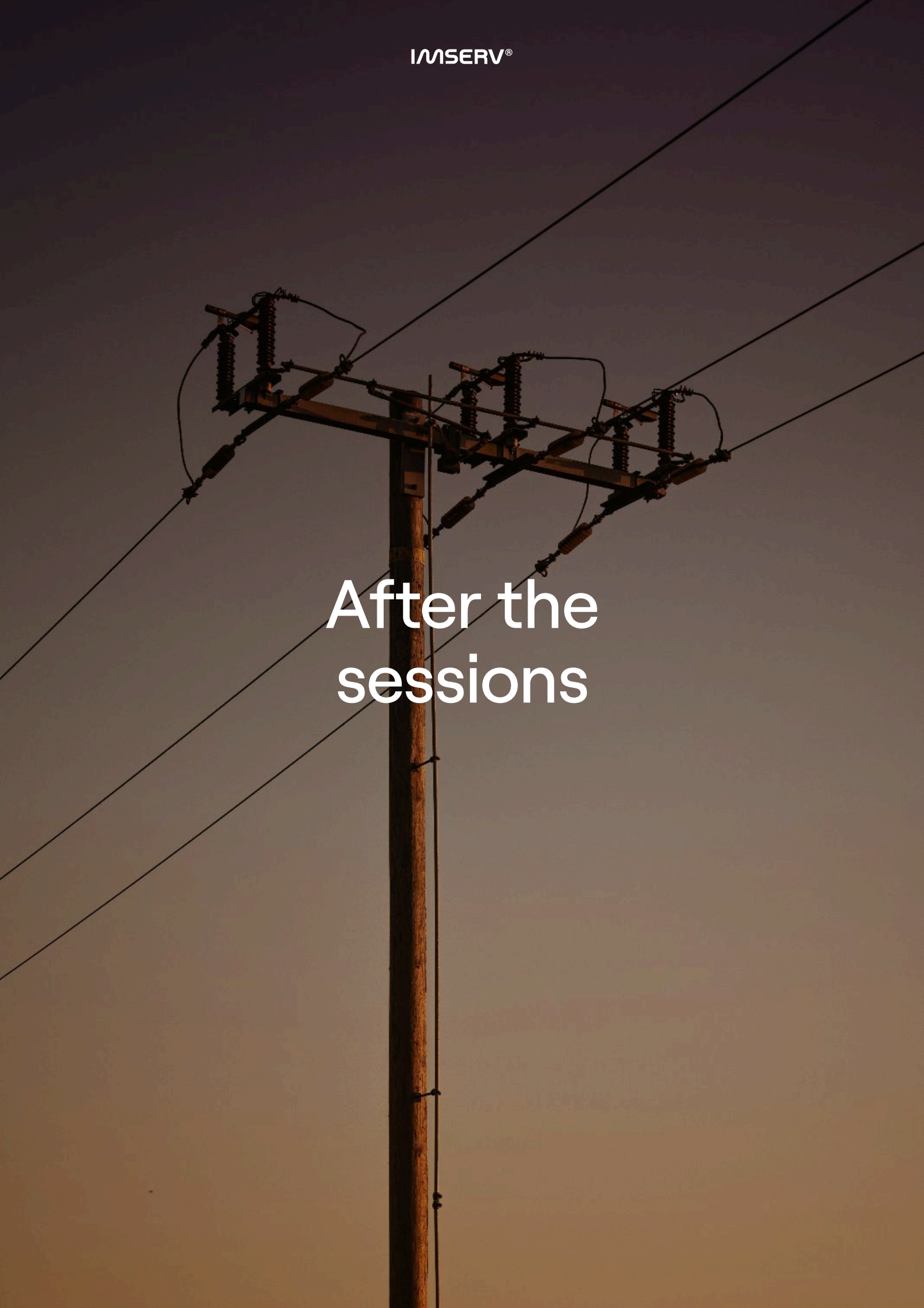
Success definitions

Success. Reached the agreed end state without help.

Success with assist. Reached it after a moderator prompt. Record the prompt.

Fail. Gave up, asked to stop, or ended somewhere else believing they were done.

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After the sessions

Objective to evidence matrix

Analysis asks one question of this page. Did the research answer each objective? An unanswered objective becomes a knowledge gap, not an invented finding.

Objective	Research question	Activity	Evidence	Measure
Example · Evaluate creation flow	Can users add a company?	Task 2	Observed task	Success, SEQ
[Objective 1]	[ ]	[Discovery / Task n]	[Behaviour, quote, rating]	[ ]
[Objective 2]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
[Objective 3]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
[Objective 4]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]

Guidance · delete before issue. The shaded row is an illustration of shape only. Remove it. Every objective on page 05 needs a row here before the first session.

Analysis and outputs

Observation before interpretation. Every claim traces back to a participant ID and a timestamp.

Approach

1. Check consent and sensitivity for every session.
2. Code against the objectives, then code openly for what we did not expect.
3. Look for patterns. Then look for contradictions and outliers.
4. Build themes with one clear idea each, not topic buckets.
5. Run Analyst, Challenger and Verifier passes. Publish only after Verifier succeeds.
6. Check every quote, count and score against the source.

Write counts as “Observed in 3 of 6 participants”. Never “most users”.

Expected outputs

- Findings report, IMSERV template
- Insights added or updated in `docs/research/insights/`
- Archetypes and journeys updated only where evidence supports it
- Experience measures updated where eligible
- Knowledge gaps recorded. No automatic next study

Risks and limitations

- Small sample. Findings are directional
- Prototype fidelity may change behaviour
- Recruitment may skew to engaged customers
- [Study-specific risk]

EVIDENCE MARKER · EVERY INSIGHT CARRIES ONE

Evidence: [n]/[N] participants · Study [ID] · P[nn], P[nn]

Note-taking sheet

Cameras off, mics muted unless invited. Do not help the participant. Capture what they did and said, not solutions. Flag timestamps.

P[nn] · Session [nn] · [Date] · Note-taker [initials]

Time	Task or question	Observation · what happened or was said	Interpretation · optional, labelled	Objective

Research team



PHOTO

[First and last name]
Research lead · Moderator

PHOTO

[First and last name]
Note-taker

PHOTO

[First and last name]
Product owner · Decision maker

PHOTO

[First and last name]
Designer · Observer

PHOTO

[First and last name]
Engineer · Observer

PHOTO

[First and last name]
Privacy contact



Thank You

[Researcher name]
[name]@imserv.com